

OP2 Opportunity Mapping

Pillar	Opportunity	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	40-50 minutes	Group Size	5-15
Mode	Team facilitation	Format	In-person or remote
Prerequisites	None	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Lack of transparency in career paths, unequal access to upskilling, lack of internal mobility awareness, limited stretch assignment access

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

Opportunity blindness is a real neurological phenomenon. The brain's reticular activating system (RAS) filters information based on what it considers relevant. If someone has never been shown that opportunities exist for them, the RAS literally filters out opportunity signals. This creates a self-reinforcing cycle: people who don't see opportunities don't look for them, and because they're not looking, they don't find them.

Making opportunities visible activates the RAS to start noticing them. This is the same mechanism that makes you suddenly see your car model everywhere after you buy one. The Opportunity Mapping exercise resets the filter.

The Exercise

Phase 1: The Opportunity Inventory (15 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"Let's map every growth opportunity available to people on this team. Not just promotions. Everything: stretch assignments, cross-functional projects, mentoring, training, job rotations, conference attendance, committee roles, leadership of initiatives. I want us to see the full landscape."

Use sticky notes/Miro. The manager should prepare by listing opportunities they're aware of, but the team should add to it. People often know about opportunities through informal channels that the manager isn't aware of.

Group the opportunities into categories: skill development, visibility/exposure, leadership experience, network expansion, lateral movement.

Phase 2: Access Audit (10 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"Now the harder question. Looking at this map, who has access to these opportunities? Are they available to everyone equally? Or are some of them invisible to certain people, or informally reserved for a select group?"

This connects to L10 (Equitable Learning) but focuses specifically on opportunity access rather than learning access. Common findings: opportunities are distributed through informal networks, managers default to the same people for stretch assignments, part-time or remote workers are systematically excluded.

Phase 3: Personal Opportunity Selection (10 minutes)

Each person selects 1-2 opportunities from the map that align with their OP1 roadmap (or general development direction if they haven't done OP1). They write down:

- Which opportunity interests them and why
- What they'd need to access it (permission, skills, timing)
- What's been stopping them from pursuing it until now

Phase 4: Manager Commitment (5 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"Here's my commitment. By our next team meeting, I will follow up individually with each of you about the opportunities you've identified. For some, I'll be able to make it happen. For others, I'll explain what needs to happen first or connect you with the right person. For any that aren't feasible right now, I'll be honest about why."

Facilitation Notes

Situation	Response
The opportunity map is surprisingly thin	This is valuable data. "If we can only identify a handful of growth opportunities for a team of [X] people, that's a problem we need to solve. What opportunities should exist that don't? Let me take this to leadership."
Someone identifies an opportunity but their manager has never offered it	Own the gap: "I should have surfaced this sooner. Let's make it happen." Do not explain why you didn't offer it; the employee doesn't need justification, they need access.

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
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OP1: Ambition Roadmap	OP1 identifies what individuals want. OP2 maps what's available. The gap between them is the action plan.	Complementary (run close together)
OP14: Stretch Assignments	OP2 identifies stretch assignment opportunities. OP14 provides the tracking and allocation framework.	OP2 feeds into OP14
L10: Equitable Learning	OP2's access audit complements L10's learning equity audit.	Complementary